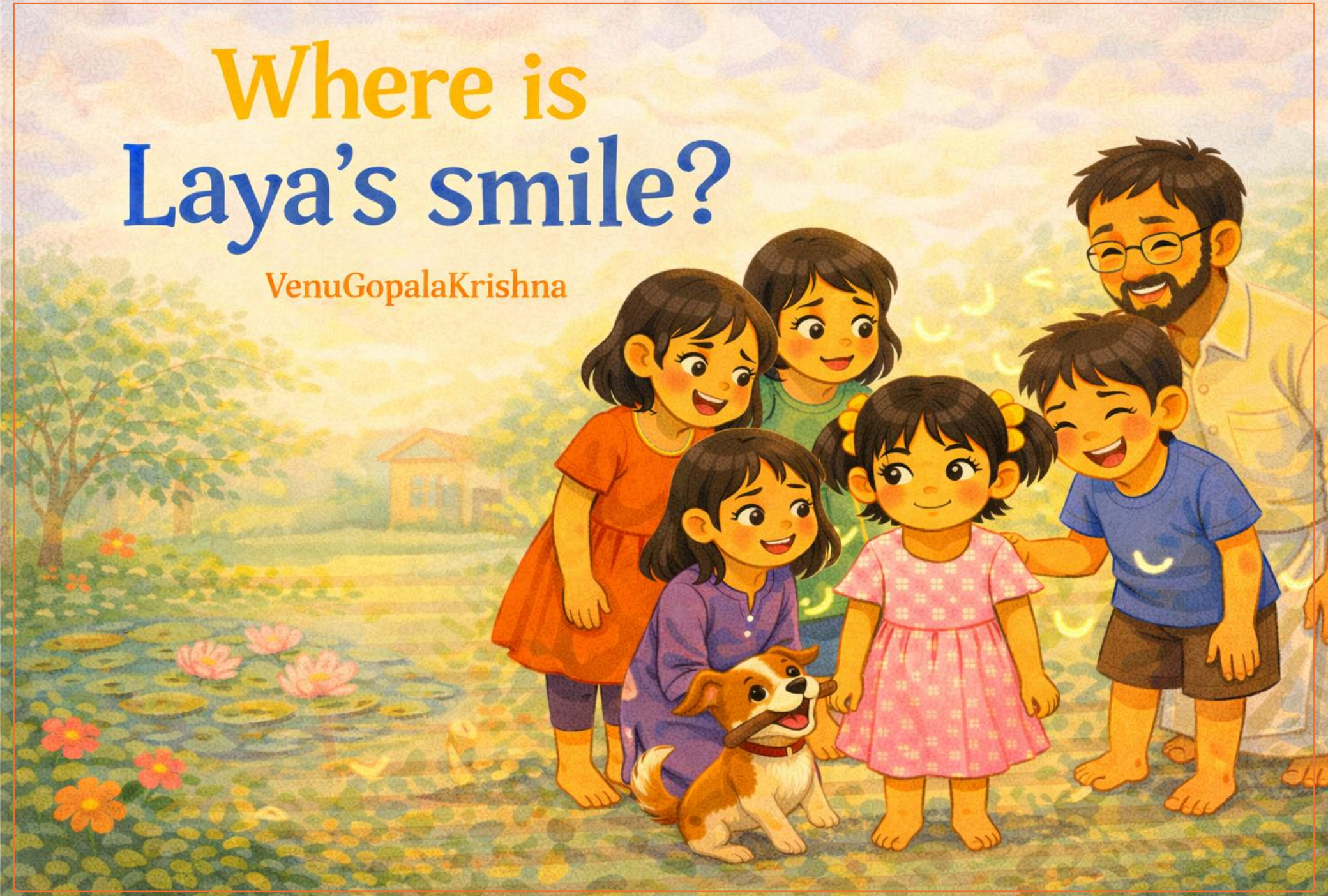
Where is Laya's smile?

VenuGopalaKrishna



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Where is Laya's smile?

Story by VenuGopalaKrishna

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It was about 8 in the morning.

Laya came to eat dosa, but the usual smile was missing from her face.

‘Ayyo, what happened to Laya's smile!?' thought everyone.

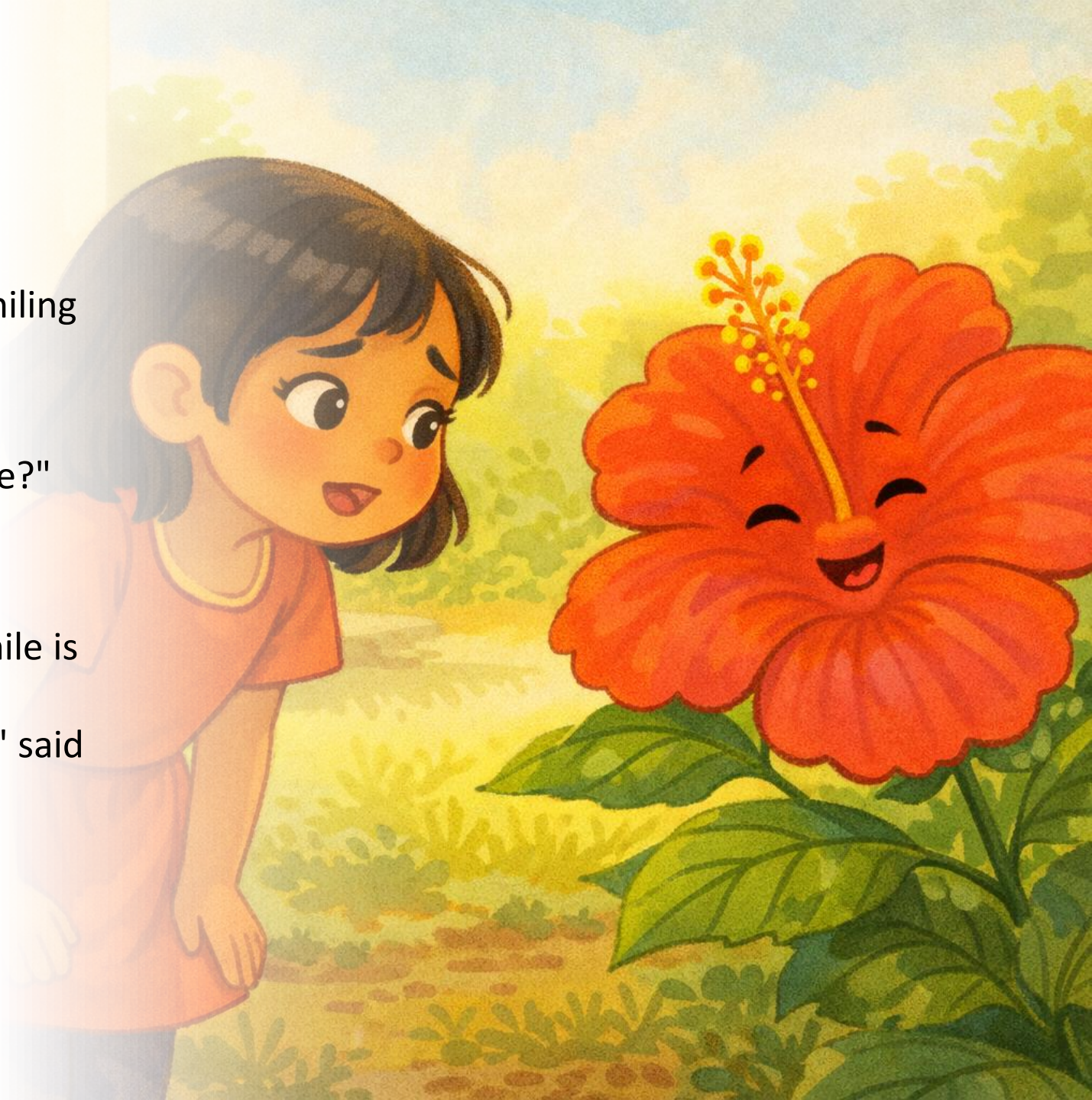
No one knew.

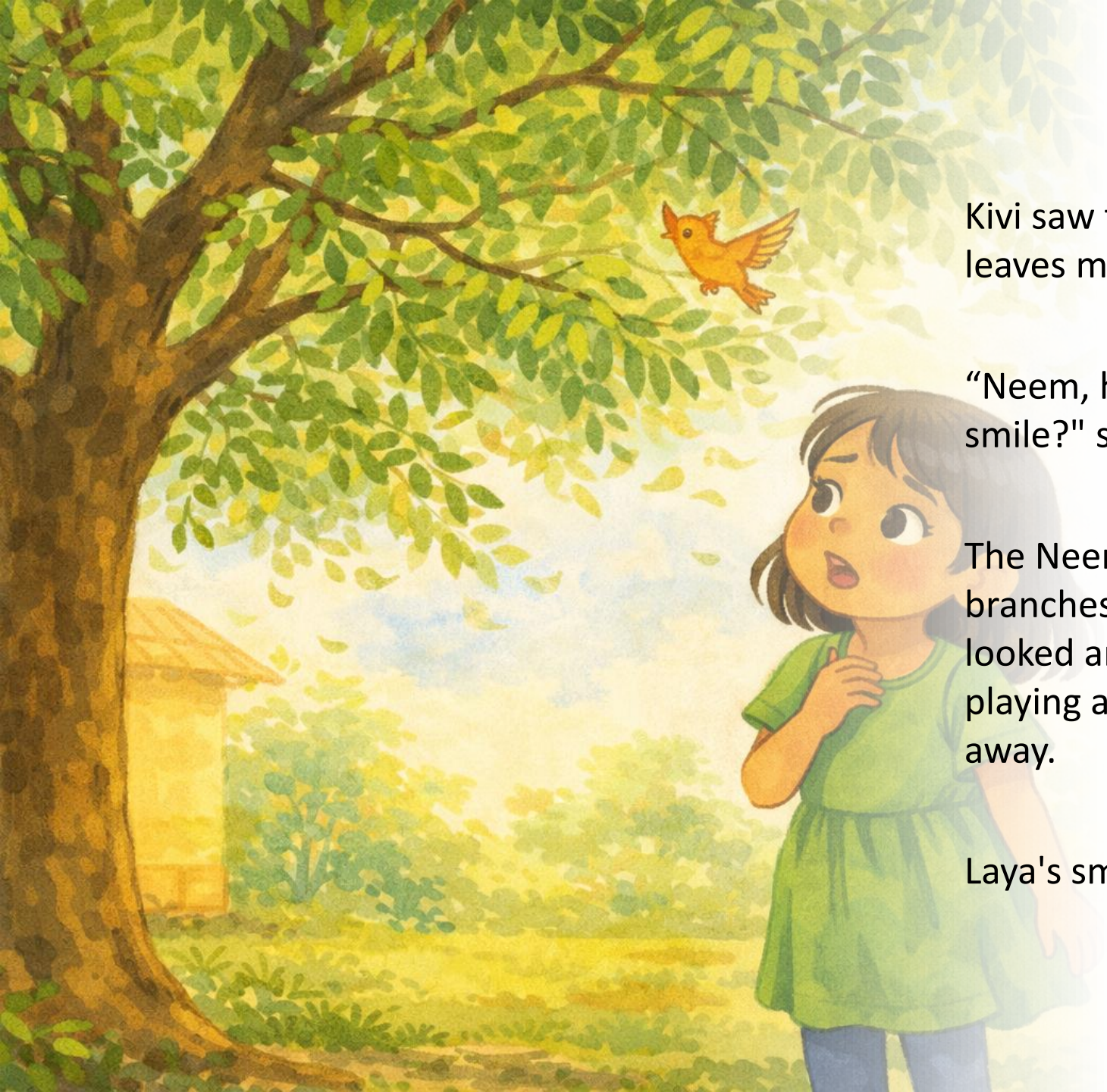
Vivanka, Kivi, Anana and Shourya went searching.

Vivanka saw a hibiscus, smiling and dancing.

'Have you seen Laya's smile?" she asked.

"I don't know dear, this smile is mine, who knows what happened to Laya's smile!" said the hibiscus.





Kivi saw the Neem tree, its green leaves murmuring in the wind.

“Neem, have you seen Laya's smile?" she asked.

The Neem tree swung its branches, dusted off its leaves and looked around. A small bird playing among the leaves flew away.

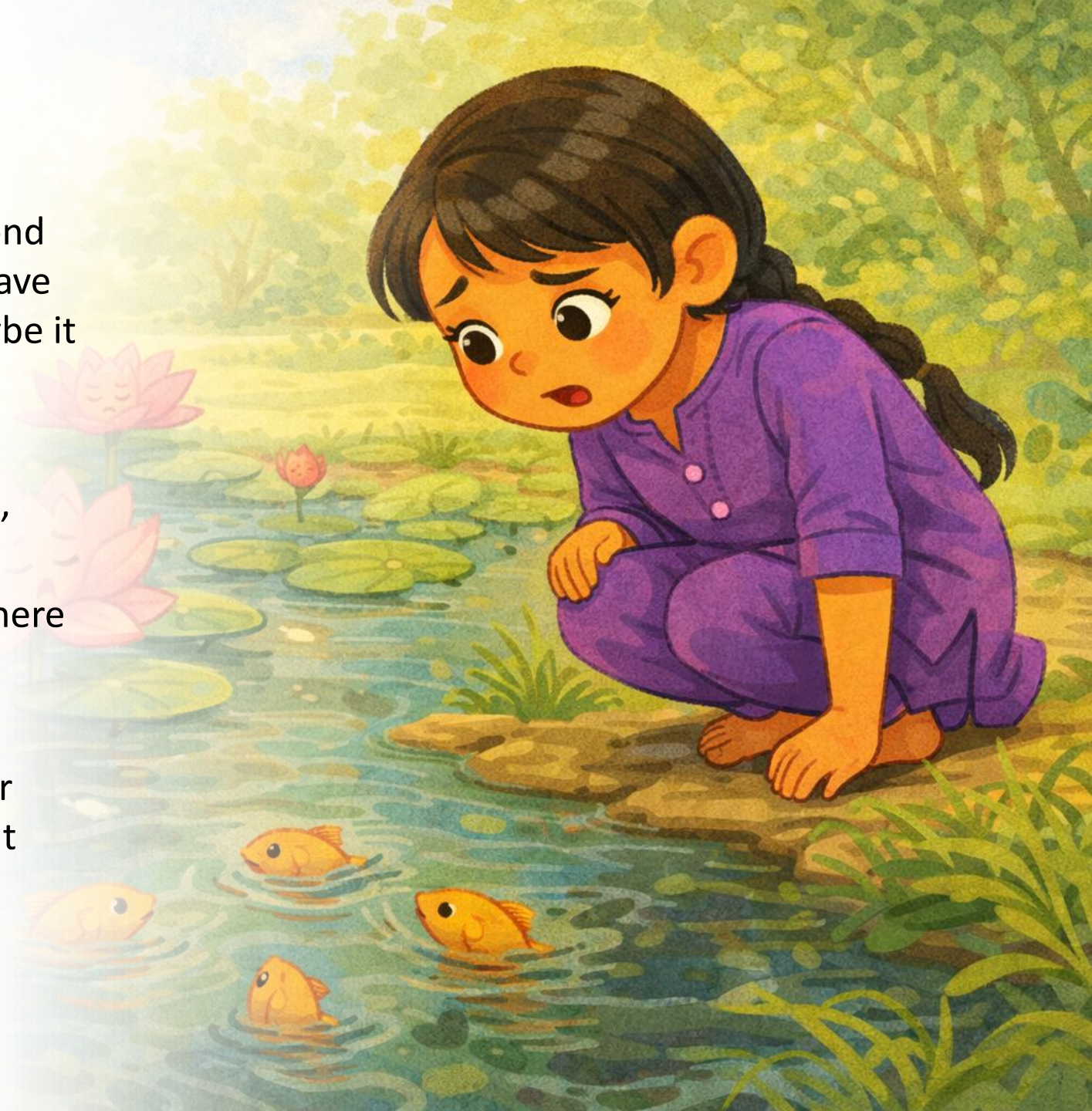
Laya's smile was not there.

Anana went to the lotus pond and asked the fish, “Fish, have you seen Laya's smile? maybe it fell into the pond..."

The fish ran here and there, searching everywhere.

"There are no smiles anywhere here!” they said.

The lotuses also shook their heads saying, “We too don't know."



Meanwhile, Thoota came along, running and jumping with a stick in his mouth.

Shourya asked him, "Thoota, have you found Laya's smile, by any chance?"

“Bow, wow, I haven't found any smiles!" replied Thoota.

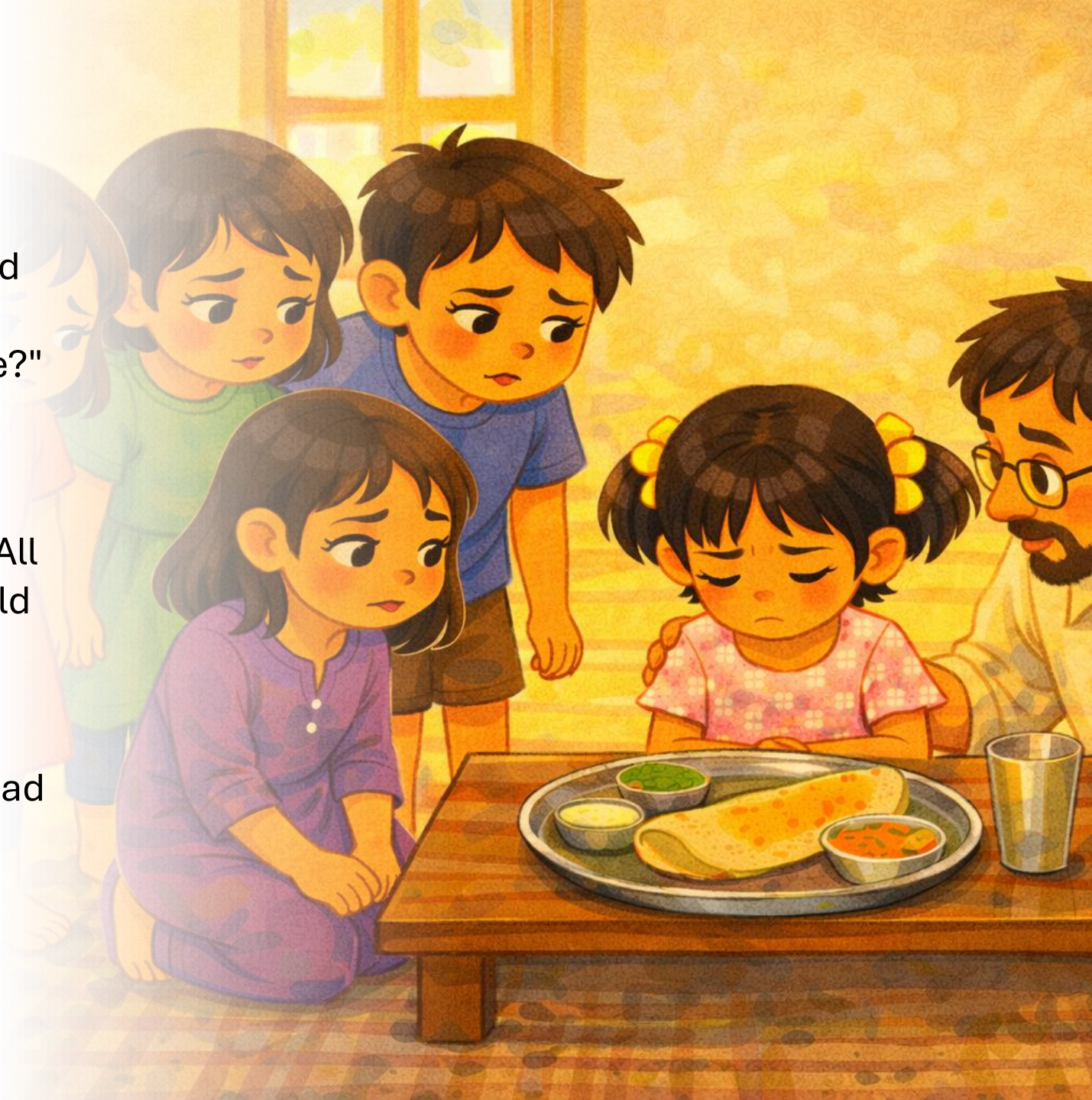
Everyone came back. By this time, Venu was sitting next to Laya.

“Venugopal, Laya's smile has gone missing!" said all the four in unison.

Venu turned to Laya and asked, “Laya, what happened to your smile?"

“Looks like you lost it somewhere," he said. “All of us searched but could not find it".

Everyone was looking sad now.



Looking at all the long faces, Laya burst out smiling!

“Oh, your smile did not go anywhere, you have been hiding it yourself!"

Everyone smiled happily!

Help Laya find her missing smile!

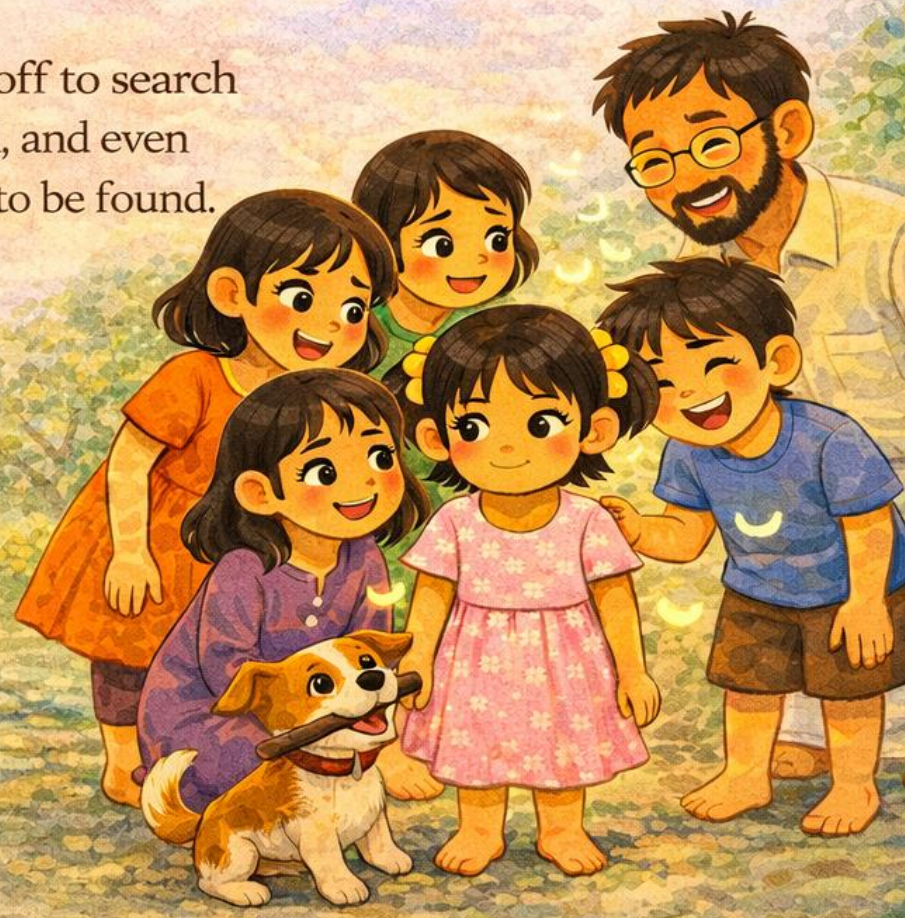
On a quiet morning at **FarmHill**, something very important has gone missing—**Laya's beautiful smile!**

Her friends Vivanka, Kivi, Anana and Shourya race off to search in the garden, under the neem tree, by the lotus pond, and even with bouncy Thoota the dog, but the smile is nowhere to be found.

Will Venu uncle's gentle question help Laya discover where her smile has been hiding all along?

This warm, tender picture book invites **young readers to:**

- Notice feelings on faces and talk about emotions in simple ways.
- See how friends and caring adults can help when someone looks sad or quiet.
- Join a playful "smile search" that ends in giggles, comfort, and connection.



About the author

VenuGopalaKrishna creates gentle, child-centered stories that speak to the hearts of young readers, making emotions and empathy easy to understand.

Age: 4–7 • Picture book